

# SERIES DOSSIER: MASTER OF KUNG FU

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Phase 6 · Disney+ Series #2 (Saga Two, Series #6, the saga's last series)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                 |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Series #               | Phase 6, Series #2 (limit: 2 this phase; <b>Phase 6's series slate, and the saga's, is now full</b> ) |
| Phase                  | Phase 6, <b>The Secret Wars Saga</b> : "Secret Wars"                                                  |
| Real title             | <i><b>MASTER OF KUNG FU</b></i> (the title of Shang-Chi's 616 series and of his Secret Wars tie-in)   |
| Decoy / codename title | <i><b>"OPEN HAND"</b></i>                                                                             |
| Premiere               | <b>Tuesday, August 5, 2031</b>                                                                        |
| Finale                 | <b>Tuesday, September 23, 2031</b>                                                                    |
| Episodes               | <b>8</b> (one a week, Tuesdays)                                                                       |
| Episode runtime        | <b>45–55 minutes</b>                                                                                  |
| Platform               | <b>Disney+</b> (Tuesday premieres)                                                                    |
| Showrunner             | Destin Daniel Cretton                                                                                 |
| Rating                 | <b>TV-14</b>                                                                                          |
| Genre + second genre   | Martial-arts action + <b>tournament epic / family drama</b>                                           |

## Episode schedule

| Ep | Title                | Airdate                 |
|----|----------------------|-------------------------|
| 1  | "K'un-Lun"           | Tue, August 5, 2031     |
| 2  | "The Emperor's Son"  | Tue, August 12, 2031    |
| 3  | "The Tournament"     | Tue, August 19, 2031    |
| 4  | "Hands of Shang-Chi" | Tue, August 26, 2031    |
| 5  | "The Schools"        | Tue, September 2, 2031  |
| 6  | "The Elixir"         | Tue, September 9, 2031  |
| 7  | "Father"             | Tue, September 16, 2031 |
| 8  | "Master of Kung Fu"  | Tue, September 23, 2031 |

## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                             | Entry                                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose series / franchise is this? | <b>SIMU LIU</b> , the only real actor to have played Shang-Chi ( <i>Shang-Chi and the Legend of the Ten Rings</i> , 2021). The Shang-Chi franchise is his. |

| Character                                                 | Actor                                                                                                 | Age at premiere |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Shang-Chi</b>                                          | Simu Liu                                                                                              | 42              |
| <b>Emperor Zheng Zu</b> ( <i>Shang-Chi's father</i> )     | Fresh casting ( <i>never played by a real actor; the 2021 film's Wenwu is not the 616 character</i> ) | —               |
| <b>Shang-Chi's half-siblings and rivals</b>               | Fresh casting                                                                                         | —               |
| <b>The masters of K'un-Lun's schools</b>                  | Fresh casting                                                                                         | —               |
| <b>Leiko Wu</b>                                           | Fresh casting                                                                                         | —               |
| <b>God Doom</b> ( <i>a voice; the post-credit scene</i> ) | Robert Downey Jr.                                                                                     | 66              |

*In memoriam: Stan Lee (1922–2018). In Episode 3, a tournament announcer in the stands, an old man in dark glasses, shouts "Excelsior!" as Shang-Chi wins his first match. Shang-Chi bows to him.*

### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                    | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary comic(s) adapted | <i>Master of Kung Fu</i> #1–4 (2015), Haden Blackman & Dalibor Talajić, the <i>Secret Wars</i> tie-in: in the <b>K'un-Lun domain</b> of Battleworld, the tyrant <b>Zheng Zu</b> rules. His son <b>Shang-Chi</b> lives outside his father's court. <b>A tournament of K'un-Lun's martial-arts schools</b> decides who rules next, and <b>Shang-Chi fights his way to his father</b> . |
| Supporting comics        | <i>Special Marvel Edition</i> #15 (1973), Steve Englehart & Jim Starlin: <b>Shang-Chi's first appearance</b> · <i>Master of Kung Fu</i> (1974–83), Doug Moench & Paul Gulacy: <b>Leiko Wu</b> , the <b>definitive run</b> · <i>Shang-Chi</i> (2020–21), Gene Luen Yang & Dike Ruan: <b>Zheng Zu</b> named, and Shang-Chi's <b>half-siblings</b>                                      |
| Nerf check               | ✓ <b>Shang-Chi is the greatest martial artist in the Marvel Universe: a master of every style</b> , fast enough to <b>catch bullets</b> , able to <b>focus his chi</b> . <b>Zheng Zu is a master sorcerer, kept alive for centuries by an elixir, and deadly with his hands</b> .                                                                                                    |

#### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | <b>93%</b> . The <i>Master of Kung Fu</i> tie-in's setting and players (the domain, the tyrant father, the tournament) are adapted closely. I've kept the smaller plot details broad on purpose, and the series fills them in. |

##### Straight from the page:

- **K'un-Lun is a Battleworld domain** ruled by **Zheng Zu** (*MoKF* 2015 #1).
- **Shang-Chi, Zheng Zu's son**, stands **against his father** (#1–4).
- **A tournament of the schools** (#1–4).
- **Shang-Chi faces Zheng Zu** (#4).
- **Zheng Zu's elixir of life** (616, Yang).
- **Shang-Chi's half-siblings** (616, Yang).

##### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| **Leiko Wu** (the Moench era's MI6 agent) is a **K'un-Lun rebel** | The domain version of **Shang-Chi's great love** |

| **The post-credit scene** sends Shang-Chi **to the war on Doomstadt** | It ties the series to *Secret Wars* |

##### POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character          | 616 powers & abilities                                                                                                                   | Shown in the series | Held back (why) | Match     |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------|-----------|
| Shang-Chi          | The greatest martial artist alive; every style; chi focus; bullet-catching reflexes; can replicate himself in a blur of speed (Yang era) | All of it           | —               | ✓<br>100% |
| Zheng Zu           | Master sorcerer; centuries old (the elixir); master martial artist                                                                       | All of it           | —               | ✓<br>100% |
| The school masters | Masters of their styles                                                                                                                  | All of it           | —               | ✓<br>100% |

## 4. STORY

| Field                | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Logline              | In a domain of Battleworld ruled by the greatest martial-arts tyrant who ever lived, his son enters the tournament that decides who will rule next, to beat his father with his bare hands. |
| Theme                | <b>Fathers and sons.</b> Shang-Chi won't be his father, and he won't be God Doom's either.                                                                                                  |
| Villain / antagonist | ZHENG ZU                                                                                                                                                                                    |

### What the season is about

- **Episodes 1–2: K'un-Lun**, a city of martial-arts schools, ruled by **Emperor Zheng Zu**. **Shang-Chi**, his estranged son, **teaches the poor to fight**. **Leiko Wu** and the rebels want him to lead them.
- **Episodes 3–4: The tournament.** Every school's champion **fights for the throne**. **Shang-Chi enters**.
- **Episodes 5–6: Shang-Chi's half-siblings**, each a **champion of a different school**, fight **him** and **each other**. **Zheng Zu's elixir is the secret of his power**.
- **Episode 7: Father and son**, alone, **in the Emperor's garden**.
- **Episode 8: Shang-Chi beats Zheng Zu** without killing him. **K'un-Lun is free**.

## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | <b>Battleworld: K'un-Lun. Monday, June 3 → Saturday, December 14, 2030.</b> ( <i>It's set before Avengers: God Emperor Doom and airs after it, like Ms. Marvel.</i> )                                                      |
| Where it's set          | <b>Battleworld: the K'un-Lun domain</b> (the Emperor's palace, the schools, the tournament arena)                                                                                                                          |
| Relative to other films | It runs <b>alongside</b> <i>Black Panther: The Infinity Gauntlet</i> and <i>Captain Marvel and the Carol Corps</i> . Its post-credit scene <b>leads into the march on Doomstadt</b> in <i>Avengers: God Emperor Doom</i> . |

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## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The series' own world

- **Shang-Chi** and **K'un-Lun** join the MCU.

### World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed             | How it appears       | Payoff                                  |
|------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>Shang-Chi</b> | His first appearance | <b>The MCU after <i>Secret Wars</i></b> |
| <b>K'un-Lun</b>  | The domain           | <b>Iron Fist</b> , in the future        |

### Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

| Seed                        | How it appears | What it means              |
|-----------------------------|----------------|----------------------------|
| <b>Another domain rises</b> | The finale     | <b>The rebellion grows</b> |

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## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENE (Episode 8)

| Field                 | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Post-credit scene     |  <b>"THE MARCH."</b> Monday, January 6, 2031, dawn. Outside K'un-Lun's gates, <b>the rebellion</b> is marching past: <b>Thors</b> overhead, <b>Hulks</b> , <b>the Ghost Racers</b> . <b>Steve Rogers</b> rides by on <b>Devil Dinosaur</b> and <b>looks down at Shang-Chi</b> .<br><b>STEVE:</b> <i>"We could use a man who fights like that."</i><br><b>Shang-Chi</b> looks back at K'un-Lun, <b>and then walks with them</b> . |
| Secret shoot codename | "FALL IN."                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scene · [x] The series' own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline · [x] **Episode count, runtimes and release pattern**